

Inclusion Criteria

- IC1** Peer-reviewed articles, conference proceedings, and edited book chapters, 2018–present.
- IC2** Grey literature from authoritative sources (National Police Chiefs' Council (NPCC), Home Office, Child Exploitation and Online Protection Centre (CEOP), National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST), Information Commissioner's Office (ICO)), 2018–present.
- IC3** NLP, machine learning, or computational linguistics applied to safeguarding, criminal justice, or analogous operational contexts.
- IC4** Grooming, CSA, or online predatory behaviour with linguistic, behavioural, or empirical focus.
- IC5** Organisational, cultural, or governance studies on technology adoption in policing or structurally comparable public-sector contexts.
- IC6** English-language sources; non-English permitted where a peer-reviewed translation or substantive abstract provides sufficient evidential grounding with explicit methodological justification.
- IC7** Pre-2018 foundational works where theoretical significance is established and no updated equivalent exists, subject to explicit justification in the synthesis narrative.

Exclusion Criteria

- EC1** Sources prior to 2018 unless meeting IC7; all exceptions recorded in the review log.
- EC2** Non-peer-reviewed opinion pieces, blog posts, or media articles without evidential grounding, unless from authoritative professional or statutory bodies.
- EC3** Studies focused solely on adult sexual offending with no transferable relevance to child safeguarding contexts.
- EC4** Technical NLP literature without contextual application to safeguarding, criminal justice, or operational deployment (foundational instructional / code text not included).
- EC5** Technology adoption studies from sectors lacking structural or cultural comparability to UK policing (e.g. private-sector contexts without analogous accountability frameworks).
- EC6** Duplicate publications; where multiple versions exist, the most recent peer-reviewed version is retained.
- EC7** Sources for which full text cannot be obtained via institutional access, inter-library loan, or open-access repositories within a reasonable retrieval window.